

Filling the chair after a cancellation

Fewer empty chairs, and no more chasing people by text.

How it works today

- 1 A cancellation shows up in Square.
- 2 Lena or Carla look through the Google Sheet of people who asked for an earlier appointment.
- 3 Several likely matches are texted at once from the salon phone, and whoever is watching the phone sorts out the replies.

What goes wrong

- Nobody records who was texted or when, so follow-up is guesswork.
- Two people say yes to the same chair, and untangling it depends on who is at the desk.
- When nobody answers, the gap is noticed late or not at all, and the chair stays empty.
- Time at the front desk goes to texting instead of clients.

"I'd be nervous about it offering the same opening to two people, or continuing after the opening is no longer available."

Lena, on what would make her distrust an automated version

THE PROTOTYPE

One opening, one orderly conversation at a time

1

Staff enter the opening
Service, stylist, and time. The screen shows who will be contacted and in what order before you start.

2

Clients are ranked
Same service only. A “required” stylist is respected. People who asked for this stylist go first, then whoever has waited longest.

3

One text at a time
The first person gets 15 minutes for a same-day opening (60 otherwise). A live countdown shows on the dashboard.

4

Yes, no, or silence
YES: confirmation text, chair held. NO or no reply: the next person is texted, and they stay on the waitlist.

5

Staff finish in Square
Book the accepted client as today. If they change their mind, one click withdraws them and resumes the search.

JUNIPER SALON · FRONT DESK

Open chairs

Each opening is one Temporal Workflow. Inspect it at <localhost:8233>.

New opening
A cancellation just showed up in Square. Tell the system what opened.

Service

Haircut (45 min)

Stylist

Lena

Starts

10/05/2026 06:30 PM

OPENING-1B0C8322

Haircut with Carla

Mon, Oct 5, 6:30 PM · 1 min per offer

Priya Nair accepted. Book them in Square to finish.

CHAIR FILLED

Priya Nair

Confirmation sent. Book them in Square to finish.

Mark booked in Square

Priya Nair changed their mind

Client phone SIMULATED

Texts are not really sent. Pick a client to see their phone and reply as them.

Priya Nair · 555-0102

Hi Priya Nair, this is Juniper Salon. A Haircut with Carla just opened on Mon, Oct 5, 6:30 PM. Reply YES to take it or NO to pass. We'll hold it for you for 1 minutes.

4:18:03 PM

You're booked! Haircut with Carla Mon, Oct

Front-desk dashboard from the prototype. Names and numbers are fictional.

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Four things the system guarantees

Never two offers at once

Each opening is a single process that holds exactly one offer at a time. A late YES from someone whose turn has passed is refused automatically, with a polite “sorry, already taken” text, and the person who holds the offer is unaffected.

Stops the moment the opening is gone

“Cancel opening” ends the process instantly and tells whoever held the offer. If the appointment time arrives first, it stops by itself. Nothing is ever sent for a dead opening.

Nobody has to watch the phone

Every offer has a countdown. When it runs out, the next person is texted without anyone noticing or remembering. The windows never run past the appointment time itself.

Nothing gets lost

Every text, reply, skip, and decision is recorded against the opening. The front desk always sees who holds the offer and who is next, and if a computer restarts the process carries on where it left off.

Underneath, the engine is **Temporal**: it keeps each opening’s state safe, runs the timers, delivers replies to the right process, and makes sure every step happens exactly once. On the right: Temporal’s own history of the demo run, where Maya’s timer fired, her late yes was answered, and Priya’s acceptance cancelled the countdown and sent the confirmation.

Event History

All

Compact

JSON

Descending

Filter

Auto Refresh On

Download

Event ID	Timestamp	Event Type	Details
46	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.89 PM PDT	Timer Started	Start To Fire Timeout 2 hours, 11 minutes, 31 seconds
45	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.89 PM PDT	Workflow Task Completed	Identity 29848@DESKTOP-DBGKRJJ
44	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.82 PM PDT	Workflow Task Started	History Size Bytes 7873
43	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.80 PM PDT	Workflow Task Scheduled	Task Queue Name 29848@DESKTOP-DBGKRJJ-e7555fca87b24f21a39b380a3f0821cf
42	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.80 PM PDT	Activity Task Completed	Result {"provider": "simulated", "providerMessageId": "bca555ae-4...
41	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.77 PM PDT	Activity Task Started	Attempt 1
40	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.77 PM PDT	Activity Task Scheduled	Activity Type sendSms
39	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.77 PM PDT	Timer Canceled	Identity 29848@DESKTOP-DBGKRJJ
38	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.77 PM PDT	Workflow Execution Update Completed	Outcome Success {"accepted": true, "outcome": "accepted", "message": "Priya ...
37	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.77 PM PDT	Workflow Execution Update Accepted	Name respondToOffer
36	Oct 5, 2026, 4:18:28.77 PM PDT	Workflow Task Completed	Identity 29848@DESKTOP-DBGKRJJ

What is simulated, and what is not built yet

SIMULATED

- **Text messages** are not really sent. They appear in an on-screen “client phone” so we can act as the client. Connecting a real texting service is a small, contained change.
- **Square and the Google Sheet** are replaced by a built-in sample waitlist of eight fictional clients. Staff enter openings by hand instead of Square announcing them.
- **Booking in Square** stays manual, exactly as today. The system just tells you when to do it.

NOT BUILT YET

- Stopping one client from holding offers for two different openings at the same time.
- A “pause and handle this one by hand” mode. Today you can skip, record a reply yourself, or cancel.
- Adding or editing waitlist clients inside the app.
- Using each client’s general availability to filter, rather than just showing it to staff.
- Reports after the fact: chairs filled, response times, no-shows.

A two-week pilot with Carla's clients

Small enough to switch off in an afternoon, real enough to learn from.

THE PILOT

- 1 Connect real texting on one salon number, for Carla's waitlist only (about 20 people).
- 2 Lena or Carla enter openings by hand when a cancellation lands; Square booking stays manual.
- 3 Keep the 15-minute window for same-day openings and 60 minutes otherwise, and adjust after week one.
- 4 Afterwards, connect Square so openings are created automatically.

WHAT WE MEASURE

- Chairs filled vs. left empty, compared with the two weeks before.
- Minutes the front desk spends on cancellations each day.
- Double-offer incidents. Target: zero.
- How often clients reply within the window, to tune the timing.

What we need from you

- Carla's current waitlist, with "required" or "preferred" marked per client.
- A yes on the wording of the four text messages.